

Stallions fighting

Zebras of the southern Serengeti mate and breed early in the year during the rainy season, when there is plenty of green grass to eat. Stallions fight each other over who will mate with a mare.

Stallions circle each other, bite, and kick out with their sharp hooves.

Zebra

On the open grassy plains of the Serengeti in eastern Africa, zebras live in family groups, called harems. A typical harem includes a stallion (male) and several mares (females) with foals. The harems gather in huge herds made up of hundreds, sometimes thousands, of zebras. Each year, the herds migrate. They are following the rains in search of fresh pastures.

Nuzzling

Stallions and mares nuzzle each other before mating. The most important, or dominant, mare in the harem breeds the most often, and her foals rank higher than the others.

Giving birth alone

Mares are pregnant for a little over a year. This means that the mares of the Serengeti have to travel long distances while pregnant. To give birth, the mother leaves the herd to hide from predators, such as cheetahs, lions, and hyenas.

Each zebra has a unique stripe pattern, like a bar code.